

Essential Eligibility Criteria

- 1. Independent Self-Care** Participants should be prepared to manage their personal care and medications with limited outside independently.
- 2. Health & Psychological Stability** To ensure that all participants can be supported safely and appropriately, students with a diagnosis or condition that may require specific considerations may be asked to provide additional documentation or medical clearance and demonstrate a period of independent stability for a minimum period of 12 months. This information helps guide the planning of reasonable accommodations and assess that the program environment can provide appropriate support.
- 3. Physician & Guardian Support** A participant's physician may be required to confirm fitness for travel and participation. Guardians play an important role in supporting disclosure and preparing students for the travel and group environment. **If health circumstances change between enrollment and departure, we ask families to update us so we can reassess accommodations.*
- 4. Openness & Adaptability** Students should have a to engage with peers, adapt to cultural differences, and navigate new environments with staff support. Respect, open communication, and a tolerance for discomfort and ambiguity are part of the learning experience.
- 5. Proactive Communication** We encourage participants to communicate directly with SSB staff when they need clarification, support, or adjustments. Staff are trained to respond and problem-solve collaboratively, but students must be able to take an active role in sharing their needs.
- 6. Resilience to Environmental Stressors** Students should expect to encounter; high heat and humidity, cold, altitude, insects, change in diet, change in time zones, sharing spaces, roommates, going without a cell phone or other technology devices and long days with structured schedules. While staff provide orientation and strategies to manage these stressors, participants should anticipate challenges and be prepared to cope with them without continuous external support
- 7. Physical Abilities** To participate fully in the program, students should be capable of engaging in program activities that may involve walking distances greater than one mile, as the campus-based nature of the program involves moving between buildings and classes.
- 8. Instructional Abilities, Situational Awareness & Judgment** Students should be able to understand and follow staff instructions communicated in English, remain aware of their surroundings, and make responsible decisions. While staff provide supervision and guidance, students share responsibilities in maintaining their own safety and contributing to the wellbeing of the group.
- 9. Independent Travel to/from Departure Point** Participants must be able to arrange (or manage) travel between home and the destination airport. (flights, arrival, etc. – unaccompanied minor services may be available with the airline)